

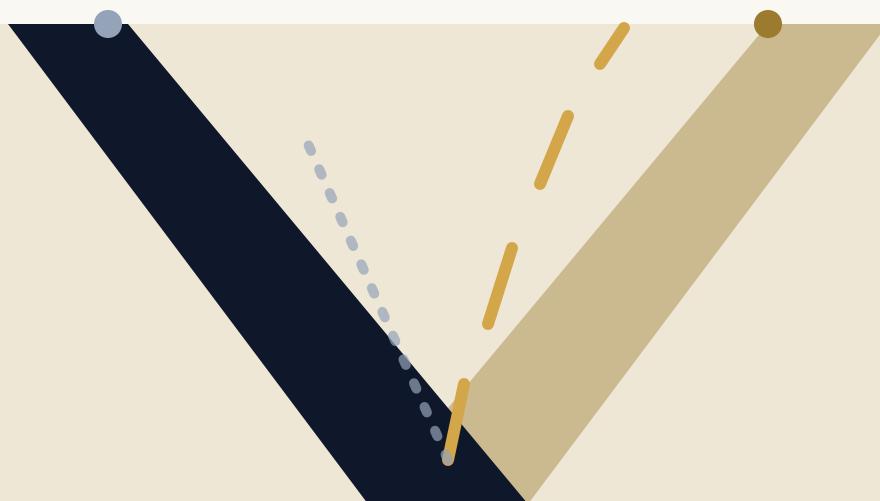


ECONOMICS IN 60 SECONDS

Issue #005

Opportunity Cost

The true price of any choice is not what you pay. It is the best thing you gave up to make it.



TIMELESS IDEAS. EVERYDAY IMPACT.

YOU HAVE TWO FREE HOURS

You spend the evening
watching a film.
What did it cost you?

MOST PEOPLE ANSWER

The price of the ticket.

AN ECONOMIST ANSWERS

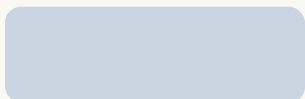
The two hours of study you will never get back.

THE COST YOU NEVER SEE

The real cost was never the ticket

Economists call it opportunity cost. The cost of any choice is the value of the best alternative you gave up to make it. Often it carries no price tag at all, which is exactly why we miss it.

THE VISIBLE COST



the ticket price

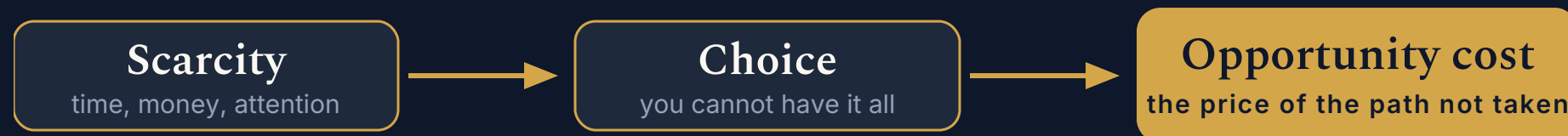
THE REAL COST



the better thing you gave up

WHERE ALL OF ECONOMICS BEGINS

Scarcity forces a choice.
Every choice has a cost.



Strip economics back to its first principle and this is what remains.

Every **yes** hides a **no**.

THE PATH GIVEN UP

THE PATH TAKEN

THE SAME HIDDEN TRADE-OFF

**Everyone pays it,
most never name it**



The student

An hour scrolling is an hour not revising.



The investor

Cash held safely is a return not earned.



The founder

Every project chosen is ten projects declined.



The government

A rupee on one programme is a rupee off another.

VISIBLE PRICE VS REAL COST

Amateurs count what they spend.
Economists count what they
give up.

WHAT YOU SEE

The money leaving
your hand

WHAT YOU MISS

The better choice
you let slip

The smartest decisions weigh the second box, the one with no receipt.

ONE QUESTION, SHARPER CHOICES

Before any yes, ask:
what am I saying no to?

Personal

Guard your hours like the scarce resource they are.

Business

The cost of a project is the best one it crowds out.

Policy

Every subsidy is a school or a road not funded.

Education

Teach the trade-off, and you teach how to think.



What is the biggest opportunity cost
most people pay without ever noticing?

Share it below. The sharpest answer shapes a future issue.



ECONOMICS IN 60 SECONDS · #005

Opportunity Cost

ONE IDEA. BETTER DECISIONS.

Next issue, #006 · Moral Hazard

By Arjun Agrawal · Associate DP Coordinator · Visiting Faculty, Fergusson College

